Sanaul Haque

Hayeon_Kim_Proposal

Course 66

Document Details

Submission ID
trn:oid:::3117:636198402

Submission Date
Oct 8, 2026, 11:39 PM GMT+6

Download Date
Oct 8, 2026, 11:41 PM GMT+6

File Name
Hayeon_Kim_Proposal.pdf

File Size
185.4 KB

8 Pages

2,332 Words

14,560 Characters

27% Overall Similarity

The combined total of all matches, including overlapping sources, for each database.

Match Groups

19 Not Cited or Quoted 16%
Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks

9 Missing Quotations 3%
Matches that are still very similar to source material

8 Missing Citation 8%
Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation

0 Cited and Quoted 0%
Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

20% Internet sources
13% Publications
26% Submitted works (Student Papers)

Match Groups

- **19** Not Cited or Quoted 16%
  Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks
- **9** Missing Quotations 3%
  Matches that are still very similar to source material
- **8** Missing Citation 8%
  Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation
- **0** Cited and Quoted 0%
  Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

20% Internet sources
13% Publications
26% Submitted works (Student Papers)

Top Sources

The sources with the highest number of matches within the submission. Overlapping sources will not be displayed.

1	Student papers	Georgia Institute of Technology Main Campus on 2025-11-24 3%
2	Student papers	Binus University International on 2026-01-08 2%
3	Student papers	Georgia Institute of Technology Main Campus on 2026-09-28 1%
4	Student papers	ASU Preparatory Academy on 2026-08-17 1%
5	Student papers	University of Wales, Lampeter on 2026-08-05 1%
6	Student papers	Seton Hall University on 2026-07-09 1%
7	Student papers	Live-Learn on 2026-04-02 1%
8	Internet	dirdosen.budiluhur.ac.id 1%
9	Internet	ijmrap.com 1%
10	Internet	tpmap.org 1%

11 Student papers
University of Nottingham on 2026-04-23 1%

12 Student papers
Los Angeles Pierce College on 2026-09-17 <1%

13 Student papers
East Central High School on 2026-05-18 <1%

14 Internet
www.ijpsy.com <1%

15 Internet
www.mdpi.com <1%

16 Internet
stevenbartlett.com <1%

17 Student papers
South Carolina Department of Education on 2026-09-25 <1%

18 Student papers
Australian Catholic University on 2026-05-06 <1%

19 Student papers
University of Strathclyde on 2026-09-22 <1%

20 Student papers
Collierville High School on 2026-04-29 <1%

21 Internet
budgetbuddy.info <1%

22 Student papers
Canvas LTI 1.3 on 2026-04-08 <1%

23 Internet
www.law.georgetown.edu <1%

24 Internet
docs.mipro-proceedings.com <1%

25 Internet

ejurnal.untan.ac.id <1%

26 Student papers

Georgia Institute of Technology Main Campus on 2025-11-30 <1%

27 Student papers

University of Maryland, Global Campus on 2026-08-26 <1%

28 Student papers

LKCFES on 2026-05-03 <1%

29 Student papers

Manuel S. Enverga University Foundation-Candelaria on 2026-04-15 <1%

30 Publication

Hesam Ghasemi, Vivek Astvansh, Amir Sepehri. "How should content creators nar... <1%

31 Publication

Reshaa F. Alruwaili. "Scroll immersion and short-form video use: Predictors of att... <1%

IARCO RESEARCH PROPOSAL

Full Legal Name: Hayeon Kim

Institution: University of Baguio Science High School

Category: Junior

Class/Grade/Year: Gap Year (Grade 12 graduate)

Country: Philippines

Major (if senior): N/A

Submission Date: September 30, 2026 (revised: Oct. 5, 2026)

Registered Email Address: winterlovehayeon@gmail.com

Research Topic: The Attention Economy's Dilemma: Short-Form Content, Cognitive Decline, and Structural Constraints on Reform within the Creator Economy

Title: The Attention Economy's Dilemma: Short-Form Content, Cognitive Decline, and Structural Constraints on Reform within the Creator Economy

Introduction

The global creator economy is now valued at over $100 billion, with globally popular platforms such as TikTok, YouTube Shorts, and Instagram Reels [10]. Every day, billions of users consume short-form video content — defined by rapid-cut sequences, algorithmically curated feeds, and viewing durations averaging under 60 seconds — for hours each day, accumulating to weeks of exposure [11]. However, even as this economy grows, an increasing body of neuroscience and psychology literature presents a parallel and troubling trend: the same content formats that power creator livelihoods are measurably impairing the cognitive functioning of their audiences [3].

Short-form media has been linked to deficits in sustained attention, prospective memory, and long-term memory retention [2], [4], [8]. Furthermore, the United Nations has drawn attention to this very economy's effect on cognition and self-determination [17], while business education researchers have begun calling for school-level responses to what is now called a cognitive crisis [12]. Despite this growing issue, the structure of social media in the creator economy — where watch time, engagement, and virality directly determine creator income — actively rewards the very content formats that neurological research flags as harmful [6], [7].

This creates a fundamental yet understudied tension: the cognitive harm is evident, but the economic architecture of the creator economy makes stopping it structurally unlikely. This study seeks to examine that tension through a systematic, comparative analysis of the two bodies of literature, and to assess whether the structural incentives of the creator economy present genuine barriers to reform.

Research Problem

While research on the cognitive effects of short-form content consumption has increased since 2019, it remains largely disconnected from scholarship on creator economy structures and their platform incentive design. Cognitive studies show this harm, while marketing and entrepreneurship researchers celebrate creator economy growth [6], [10]. Moreover, no study has formally examined whether these two bodies of literature are in structural conflict, or whether the economic incentives that sustain the creator economy make cognitive harm mitigation a systemic impossibility rather than a solvable design problem.

This gap is urgent. As platforms expand their short-form offerings and creator monetization deepens its dependence on engagement metrics, a window for meaningful intervention may be narrowing [5], [18]. A comparative analysis that maps the conflict between these two fields is therefore both timely and necessary.

Research Question

To what extent do the structural incentives of the creator economy present barriers to mitigating the adverse effects of short-form media consumption on memory retention and cognitive functioning?

Literature Review

Cognitive Effects of Short-Form Media

A consistent body of evidence links short-form video consumption to measurable cognitive decline. Chiossi et al. [4] demonstrated that context-switching induced by short-form video degrades prospective memory — the capacity to remember to perform future-intended actions. Yan et al. [8], using electroencephalographic (EEG) measurement, found that mobile short-video use negatively impacts attentional functioning at the neural level. A systematic review by Arouch et al. [3] synthesized evidence across cognitive and mental health outcomes, concluding that short-form video use is broadly associated with poorer cognitive performance. Head [15] and Alruwaili [14] similarly found that sustained short-form video consumption predicts reduced attention span, increased memory fatigue, and diminished recall. Mona et al. [13] further identified short video addiction as a significant predictor of cognitive impairment in adolescents and youth, recommending interventions that promote self-regulation and controlled usage.

Neurologically, the mechanism proposed across these studies centers on dopaminergic reward loops, in which rapid content switching triggers repeated dopamine release, reducing the brain's tolerance for sustained cognitive effort [16]. The collapse of cognitive autonomy — defined as the capacity to direct one's own attention deliberately — has been described as a systemic outcome of sustained attention economy exposure [18]. Chen [2] specifically linked TikTok consumption in young adults to measurable deficits in sustained attention and memory, using behavioral testing rather than self-report, making the evidence stronger. The United Nations [17] has formally characterized this as a public cognitive health concern requiring policy-level attention.

Creator Economy Incentive Structures

The creator economy, which encompasses individuals who monetize digital content production across platforms, is structurally dependent on engagement maximization [6]. Peres et al. [6] identify the creator economy as a distinct economic paradigm in which platform algorithms, creator revenue, and audience engagement form a tightly coupled incentive loop. Bleier et al. [7] specifically examine platform roles in this ecosystem, finding that platforms systematically amplify content that maximizes watch time and interaction, because such content drives advertising revenue. This algorithmic logic directly incentivizes the short, stimulating, rapid-cut content formats that cognitive science identifies as cognitively harmful [5].

Gunawan and Setyaningsih [10] document that the creator economy continues to grow rapidly, with creator income increasingly tied to platform-native monetization tools — all of which reward the same engagement metrics. Antonizzi and Smuts [9] situate the creator economy within broader digital entrepreneurship trends, noting that platform-driven revenue models have become structurally entrenched. Tran [12] argues that even business education — which shapes future platforms and brand leaders — has yet to seriously engage with the cognitive consequences of the attention economy it helps sustain. Zeng [11] further demonstrates that short-form video consumption actively shapes consumer decision-making in ways that deepen platform dependency, creating a feedback loop that reinforces both creator and platform incentives to produce more of the same content.

The Structural Conflict

Taken together, the two streams reveal a structural conflict that neither field has formally examined in relation to the other: cognitive science prescribes reducing short-form content exposure, while the creator economy's economic architecture actively incentivizes its expansion. Siddantham et al. [1] note that despite growing evidence of harm, practical intervention remains limited, partly because the very platforms best positioned to implement change are economically disincentivized from doing so. Enders [5] similarly observes that even as the scientific consensus on cognitive harm solidifies, platform responses remain superficial. Bleier et al. [7] further confirm that platform amplification logic makes this conflict self-reinforcing. This gap between evidence and incentive is the central problem this study addresses.

Proposed Methodology

This study will employ a qualitative systematic literature review and comparative analysis framework. The methodology will be organized into three phases.

Phase 1 — Literature Identification and Screening: Peer-reviewed studies, institutional reports, and scholarly articles published between 2019 and 2026 will be collected and identified via Google Scholar, PubMed, SSRN, and institutional repositories. Inclusion criteria will require studies to address either (a) the cognitive or neurological effects of short-form video consumption, or (b) the economic structures, incentive designs, or platform mechanics of the creator economy. Studies addressing both will be prioritized, and some prominent individual topic studies will be included.

Phase 2 — Comparative Framework Construction: Findings from each stream will be coded thematically. Stream 1 sources will be analyzed for documented cognitive harms and proposed mitigations. Stream 2 sources will be analyzed for structural incentive mechanisms and barriers to behavioral reform in the creator economy. A comparative matrix will then be constructed to identify where the two streams conflict. Specifically, it will focus on where a mitigation proposed by cognitive science is structurally undermined by creator economy incentives.

Phase 3 — Synthesis and Assessment: The comparative matrix will be used to assess the degree to which structural incentives of the creator economy form genuine barriers to reform, and to identify any points of potential alignment where creator economy incentives and cognitive harm reduction could be reconciled.

Ethical Considerations: This study will not involve any primary human participants to ensure that ethical risks are minimal. All sources will be properly cited in accordance with IEEE citation standards. No data will be fabricated, and limitations of each source will be acknowledged in the analysis.

Expected Outcomes and Significance

This study aims to demonstrate that the structural incentives of the creator economy are not incidentally misaligned with cognitive harm mitigation, rather they are systematically misaligned. Platform monetization models, algorithmic amplification logic, and creator revenue dependencies collectively constitute a structural barrier that makes meaningful reform unlikely under current economic conditions.

The significance of this finding is as follows: (a) First, it will reframe the cognitive harm problem not as a consumer behavior challenge but as a structural economics problem — requiring policy-level, not just individual-level, solutions. (b) Second, it will provide a foundation for future research into platform regulation, alternative creator monetization models, and digital literacy curricula that account for structural constraints. (c) Third, it will advance the convergence of cognitive science and marketing/entrepreneurship by connecting their findings, as these fields currently investigate the phenomenon in parallel but without cross-disciplinary discussion.

Limitations

This study is bounded by the availability of open-access literature, as several high-value studies remain behind institutional paywalls. The comparative framework is qualitative and does not quantify the magnitude of structural barriers, only their presence and nature. Additionally, the creator economy is a rapidly evolving field, and findings may shift as platform monetization models change. The study does not conduct primary data collection, limiting causal claims.

Conclusion

The cognitive costs of short-form media consumption are no longer speculative. They are documented across neuroscientific, psychological, and behavioral literature. Nonetheless, the creator economy — itself a part of the broader attention economy — produces and monetizes this short-form content, and is structurally rewarded for doing so. This study proposes that the absence of meaningful reform is not a failure of awareness, but a predictable outcome of misaligned economic incentives. By formally mapping this structural conflict, this research aims to provide a clearer foundation for the policy, platform, and educational interventions that cognitive health in the digital age demands.

Research Timeline

The study will be completed within a six-week period:

Week 1: Literature identification, database search, and source screening.

Week 2: Thematic coding of Stream 1 (cognitive science) sources.

Week 3: Thematic coding of Stream 2 (creator economy) sources and comparative matrix construction.

Week 4: Synthesis, conflict mapping, and drafting of findings.

Week 5: Writing, revision, and formatting of final proposal.

Week 6: Proofreading, plagiarism check, and final submission.

References

[1] S. Siddantham, P. Sridhar, and V. Thota, "Impact of short-form video content on attention span and memory retention," SSRN, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=6676438

[2] K. Chen, "Impacts of Short-Form Media Use on Sustained Attention and Memory: A Behavioral Study of TikTok Consumption in Young Adults," version 1, Stanford Digital Repository, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://purl.stanford.edu/zb094wm9033/version/1. doi: 10.25740/zb094wm9033.

[3] S. Arouch, D. Edgcumbe, S. Pezaro, and K. da Silva, "The Impact of Short-Form Video Use on Cognitive and Mental Health Outcomes: A Systematic Review," Aug. 2025, doi: 10.1101/2025.08.27.25334540.

[4] F. Chiossi, L. Haliburton, C. Ou, A. M. Butz, and A. Schmidt, "Short-Form Videos Degrade Our Capacity to Retain Intentions: Effect of Context Switching On Prospective Memory," Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, pp. 1–15, Apr. 2023, doi: 10.1145/3544548.3580778.

[5] C. Enders, "Zuckerberg says the science isn't settled. But the harms of short-form video on the brain are starting to show," The Guardian, Sep. 14, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2026/sep/14/zuckerberg-short-form-video-cognitive-harm [Accessed: Sep. 21, 2026].

[6] R. Peres, M. Schreier, D. A. Schweidel, and A. Sorescu, "The creator economy: An introduction and a call for scholarly research," International Journal of Research in Marketing, vol. 41, no. 3, pp. 403–410, Sept. 2024, doi: 10.1016/j.ijresmar.2024.07.005.

[7] A. Bleier, B. L. Fossen, and M. Shapira, "On the role of social media platforms in the creator economy," International Journal of Research in Marketing, vol. 41, no. 3, pp. 411–426, Sept. 2024, doi: 10.1016/j.ijresmar.2024.06.006.

[8] T. Yan, C. Su, W. Xue, Y. Hu, and H. Zhou, "Mobile phone short video use negatively impacts attention functions: an EEG study," Frontiers in Human Neuroscience, vol. 18, June 2024, doi: 10.3389/fnhum.2024.1383913.

[9] J. Antonizzi and H. Smuts, "The Characteristics of Digital Entrepreneurship and Digital Transformation: A Systematic Literature Review," Lecture Notes in Computer Science, pp. 239–251, 2020, doi: 10.1007/978-3-030-44999-5_20.

[10] W. B. Gunawan and P. A. Setyaningsih, "Welcoming the Creator Economy for Content Creators: Trends, Challenges, and Insights," International Journal of Kita Kreatif, pp. 90–104, May 2026, doi: 10.24815/ijkk.v3i2.1192.

[11] C. Zeng, "Unveiling the Impact of Short Videos: Consumption Behavior and Decision-Making in the Digital Age," Highlights in Business, Economics and Management, vol. 21, pp. 469–474, Dec. 2023, doi: 10.54097/hbem.v21i.14538.

[12] S. Tran, "The Attention Economy's Challenge: How Business Schools Must Address the Cognitive Crisis," Global Focus Magazine, Feb. 19, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://globalfocusmagazine.com/the-attention-economys-challenge-how-business-schools-must-address-the-cognitive-crisis/

[13] A. E. Mona et al., "Short video addiction and its impact on cognitive functioning in adolescents and youth: a systematic review," International Journal of Adolescence and Youth, Jan. 2026. doi: 10.1080/02673843.2026.2623337.

[14] R. F. Alruwaili, "Scroll immersion and short-form video use: Predictors of attention, memory, and fatigue among Saudi social media users," Acta Psychologica, vol. 260, p. 105674, Oct. 2025, doi: 10.1016/j.actpsy.2025.105674.

[15] K. R. Head, "Short-form Video Use and Sustained Attention: A Narrative Review (2019–2025)," ResearchGate, vol. 2, no. 4, pp. 60–67, Oct. 2025, doi: 10.6084/m9.figshare.30648764.

[16] F. M. Simarmata, "The Decline of Attention Span in the Digital Era," Swiss German University, Feb. 2, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://sgu.ac.id/the-decline-of-attention-span-in-the-digital-era/

[17] United Nations, The Attention Economy, United Nations, Feb. 2025. [Online]. Available: https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/attention_economy_feb.pdf. [Accessed: Sep. 21, 2026].

[18] R. H. Masoud, "The Attention Economy and the Collapse of Cognitive Autonomy," The Denny Center for Democratic Capitalism, Georgetown Law, Jul. 15, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://www.law.georgetown.edu/denny-center/blog/the-attention-economy/